of her apartment. In one, Lorde stands outside by a door, a large bouquet of flowers clutched to her spring jacket, her bag leaning against her door, as if she had paused momentarily before reentering. Most others revel in small details of the apartment, including her desk from multiple angles, open windows and doorways, furniture she has rearranged within the apartment, and a sight line from her desk and a rose in a vase facing toward the greenery outside (fig. 4.4). (On the back of another print, an inscription reads, "As you can see, I tried to decorate the drab out, first thing.")[39] In the images taken in public spaces, Lorde appears as a figure making sense of her surroundings. In several photographs, each taken with varying angles of the unmistakable cobblestone patterns of German streets (fig. 4.5). According to Schultz, she was transfixed by this fine detail of the city's common street areas. Here, the poet traces and indexes the rough edges and intricate designs of the city's built environment, the perspective suggesting that the camera is inches off the ground but varied in each image.

Other images, however, focus on the multiple facets of divided Berlin and its transnational character. One likely taken from a car in West Berlin (fig. 4.6) features a street corner with a long view down a residential street. From this vantage, a message displayed on the tall firewall of a building reads, "EIN VOLK BRAUCHT FRIEDEN / HANDE WEG VON NICARAGUA" (A People need peace / hands off Nicaragua), bringing American geopolitics back into her frame. Another photograph (fig. 4.7) is a detached shot of East Berlin's Alexanderplatz, the only visual artifact from the city's eastern half in this cache. The image captures the socialist public square from its edges, and the iconic World Clock is pictured in the middle distance. The clock, dedicated in 1969, contains an embossed world map and lists world capitals, including those from the socialist bloc. A yellow sign is inscribed with the designation "BERLIN" without naming its location in the East. Lorde's image is taken from a considerable space from these elements and other people, marking a distance to take in the full scene. In each of these images, she encounters text in public spaces that map geopolitical resonances and connections beyond the limits of the divided city.

As Lorde explored the cultural and topographical contours of historic Berlin on both sides of the Wall, much of her poetic and literary work focused on dialogue and interaction with women writers and activists. She conducted regular poetry readings and discussions with West German feminists about anti-Semitism, homophobia, lesbian identity, and racism, in